

Question:

A 29-year-old man presents to his primary care provider complaining of testicular pain. He reports a four-day history of dull chronic pain in his left testicle that is worse with standing. His past medical history is notable for asthma and major depressive disorder. He takes inhaled albuterol as needed and sertraline. He is sexually active with a single female partner and always uses barrier protection. His temperature is 99.2°F (37.3°C), blood pressure is 125/75 mmHg, pulse is 85/min, and respirations are 17/min. Physical examination reveals a non-tender twisted mass along the left spermatic cord that disappears when the patient lies supine. This patient’s condition most likely stems from decreased laminar flow at which of the following vascular junctions?

Answer Choices:

- A. Left testicular vein – Left renal vein
- B. Left testicular vein – Inferior vena cava
- C. Descending aorta – Left testicular artery
- D. Left testicular vein – Left internal iliac vein

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptom of a non-tender twisted mass along the left spermatic cord that disappears when lying supine is a characteristic of a spermatocele or a varicocele, which is an enlargement of the veins in the pampiniform plexus in the scrotum, specifically at the junction of the testicular vein and the renal vein, which can cause a backup of blood and lead to a painful twisting of the testicle (known as a varicocele).</think>
<answer> A. Left testicular vein – Left renal vein </answer>

